

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding Reasoning Paths :

- 1 . **Depressed mood + decreased energy + decreased concentration** â‡™ Major depressive disorder (MDD).
- 2 . **Guilt from past problems + suicidal ideations** â‡™ Major depressive disorder .
- 3 . **Poor concentration and indecisiveness** â‡™ Major depressive disorder .
- 4 . **Feelings of life being cursed and pessimistic outlook** â‡™ Major depressive disorder .
- 5 . **Extreme pessimism** â‡™ Major depressive disorder .
- 6 . **Worsening symptoms over 2 weeks** â‡™ Major depressive disorder .
- 7 . **No sleep disturbance** â‡™ Rule out bipolar disorder and mania .
- 8 . **No psychotic symptoms** â‡™ Rule out schizophrenia or other psychotic disorders .
- 9 . **No acute stressors or history of trauma** â‡™ Rule out stress-related disorders .

Reasoning Process :

- 1 . **Initial Presentation** : The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember , with a pessimistic outlook on life . He also describes worsening suicidal ideations , guilt from past problems , and poor concentration . These symptoms are indicative of a prolonged or recurrent depressive disorder .
- 2 . **Symptoms Analysis** :
 - **Depressed mood** : A core symptom of depression .
 - **Decreased energy and concentration** : Common in depression , particularly major depressive disorder .
 - **Increased suicidal ideations** : A severe symptom that strongly suggests depression , as it is rarely seen in other psychiatric disorders .
 - **Guilt and poor decision-making** : Further evidence of depressive symptoms .
- 3 . **Duration of Symptoms** : The patient reports worsening symptoms over the past 2 weeks , but the core symptoms (depressed mood , decreased energy , concentration , and poor decision-making) likely have a longer history , consistent with a chronic or recurrent depressive disorder .
- 4 . **Rule Out Other Diagnoses** :
 - **Bipolar disorder** : There are no signs of manic or hypomanic episodes , such as elevated mood , increased activity , or grandiosity . The symptoms are more consistent with a depressive presentation .
 - **Schizophrenia or other psychotic disorders** : The patient does not report any delusions , hallucinations , or other psychotic symptoms .
 - **Stress-related disorders** : There is no mention of acute stressors or trauma triggering these symptoms .
 - **Personality disorders** : While the patientâ€™s pessimism and poor decision-making may be attributed to personality traits , the severity and persistence of the symptoms (e.g . , suicidal ideations) are more characteristic of a depressive disorder than a personality disorder .
- 5 . **Major Depressive Disorder (MDD)** :
 - MDD is the most fitting diagnosis because it encompasses the patientâ€™s core symptoms (depressed mood , decreased energy , concentration , suicidal ideations , guilt , and poor decision-making) and the chronic nature of the illness .
 - The worsening of symptoms over 2 weeks is not uncommon in MDD , especially if left untreated .

Conclusion :

The patient most likely has major depressive disorder .

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< answer >

The patient is likely to show anhedonia .

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